

Of course, most pensions are also a form of investing – and an element of financial wellbeing that is often neglected, because we assume that it's something that we don't need to think about until 'later'. It's never really too early or too late to start thinking about investing in funds or your pension, but there are a few elements of your financial health that it's wise to have under wraps before you start to invest your money:

- Paying off problem or expensive debt
- Having that emergency fund saved
- Successfully living with your budget, and within your means
- Having some monthly funds – even as little as £10 – that you don't need and won't miss

Once you meet these criteria, it's a good idea to learn the basics of the stock market and research the different investing options available to you – and not on TikTok. In fact, it's a good idea to be cautious about any investing advice on social media, because there are some rogue ideas out there from unaccredited sources. The very last stumbling block anyone needs on their journey towards financial wellbeing is to lose money on risky investments. The right approach is usually slow and steady, with a wish to grow your money over a number of years, rather than seeing investing as a short-term money-making gambit. See the Further Reading section at the back of this book for a couple of good books to use as a starting point. There is now an absolute wealth of ethical investing options, including with most pensions, so if you'd rather avoid